

The Legend of Sweeney Todd

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Sweeney Todd, known as the “demon barber of Fleet Street,” first appeared in 1846 in *The String of Pearls*. The story follows Todd, a barber who murders his customers and helps Mrs Lovett turn them into meat pies.

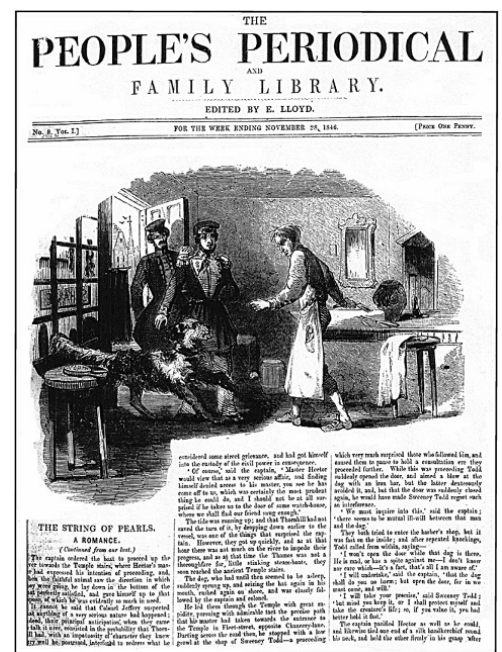
The story also follows Johanna, Tobias, and others as they try to uncover Todd’s crimes. In the end, Todd is hanged and Mrs Lovett dies from poison.

Although fictional, Todd’s barbershop is said to be on Fleet Street, near the site of the Old Bank of England pub. The story was written in a simple, dramatic style popular in “penny bloods,” cheap and sensational stories of the time.

The story reflects fears about life in 19th-century London, including crowded streets, poverty, and crime. Its mix of horror, suspense, and social commentary has helped Sweeney Todd remain popular in literature, theatre, and film.



St Dunstan-In-the-West

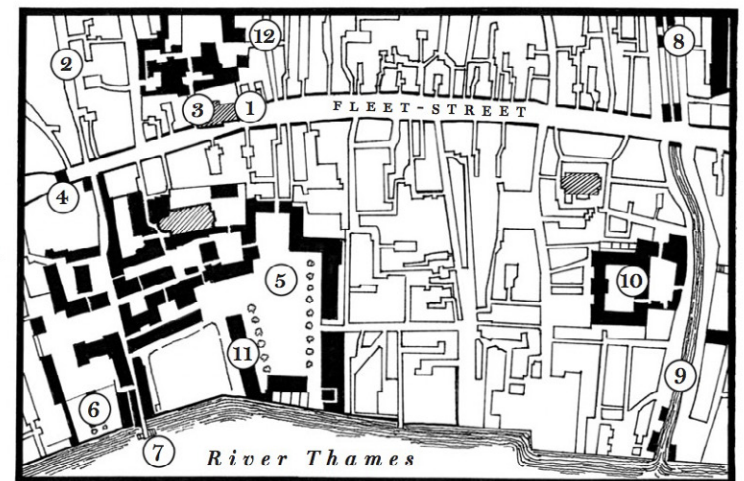


One of the alleged homes of Sweeney Todd. Fleet Street.

SWEENEY TODD'S LONDON

KEY

1. Sweeney Todd's barber shop (186 Fleet-street)
2. Mrs Lovett's Pie-shop (Bell-yard)
3. St Dunstan's church (St Dunstan in the West)
4. Temple-bar
5. The Temple
6. Temple-gardens
7. Temple-stairs
8. Fleet Market
9. Fleet Ditch
10. Bridewell Prison
11. Paper-buildings
12. Fetter-lane



A map by Robert Mack published in "Sweeney Todd: the demon barber of Fleet Street", 2010